



Delaware County Council Meeting July 25th 2023

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=l2gWX9QscS8
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Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer opened the July 25th County Council meeting at [00:00:29](#). Public questions could be directed to councildist@co.delaware.in.us or individual council member emails.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Presiding Officer / Council President:** Identified via roll call and proceedings.
 - **Members Present:** Mr. Flanagan, Mr. Hughes, Mr. Gantz, Mr. Mockel, Mr. Webb, Mr. Whitehead, Ms. Piper (Note: exact name spellings reflect roll-call phonetic transcriptions).
 - **Members Absent:** None noted.

Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Opening Pledge of Allegiance led by James Carmichael ([00:03:31](#)).
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Motion to approve prior meeting minutes carried by voice/roll call vote ([00:01:33](#)).
 - June 27th County Council meeting minutes approved following a motion and roll call vote ([00:01:53](#)).

Substantive Business & Board Action

All transfer requests detailed below received a favorable recommendation from the Finance Committee prior to council presentation.

- **00:02:17 County General Fund Transfers: Assessor (Dept. 134)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** James Carmichael, County Assessor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Assessor presented line-item transfers resulting in a net total of zero: negative \$19,104 from salaries to positive \$14,104 for salaries and positive \$5,000 for computer replacement.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:03:04 County General Fund Transfers: Circuit Courts (Dept. 138)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Court representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transfer of \$14,097 from vacant assistant court reporter/court bailiff salary to active staff. Noted the position was open June 30th due to an unexpected vacancy, operating temporarily with part-time assistance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:04:41 County General Fund Transfers: Clerk (Dept. 125)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Rick (Clerk's office).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$7,000 from part-time and \$3,600 from bank fees to positive \$10,600 for computer equipment (net total zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:05:41 County General Fund Transfers: Jail (Dept. 145)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Standard salary transfers for replacing three correctional officers who left. Staffing noted as down 10-11 officers (nearly an entire shift), forcing increased reliance on overtime.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:07:59 Other / American Rescue Plan (ARP) Fund Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred remaining project balances (including \$96,000 from general ARP and \$50,000 from ARP administration costs, plus FICA/PERF adjustments) into the Mental Health and Rehab facility project fund (total transfer of zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:09:13 Grant Transfers: High-Tech Crimes Unit (HTCU)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Zimmer, Director for the High-Tech Crimes Unit.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$30,000 from renovations to forensic software and equipment. Zimmer noted that space renovation costs for moving to the third floor escalated from an initial estimate of \$50,000 closer to \$500,000, requiring

phased execution. A \$5,000 rapid grant was secured from Ball Brothers for planning costs.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:10:47 Jail Fund Transfers (Dept. 145)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Positional salary reallocations for correctional officer lines (totaling zero).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:11:24 Motor Vehicle Highway Fund Transfers (Dept. 1176)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salary reallocations between truck driver positions reflecting tenure differences (net zero total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:13:13 Prosecutor Fund Transfers (Dept. 137)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Prosecutor's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$17,329.87 from deputy prosecutor salary to computers (net zero total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:13:48 Clerk Perpetuation Fund Transfers (Dept. 1119)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Clerk's office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$3,000 from Storage Rental to Office Machines. Noted that historical off-site file storage units across town have been successfully consolidated under one roof at the Justice Center, eliminating future annual rental fees.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:16:58 Addendum 1: Communications (Dept. 124)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Dr. Commons.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Reallocated communication line items, adding \$20,000 to overtime, \$15,000 to holiday pay, and \$1,500 to professional cleaning. Dr. Commons explained that switching to 12-hour shifts caused more staff to take holiday pay directly rather than accumulating comp time.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:19:26 EMS Fund Transfers (Dept. 155)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salary transfers for paramedics and Advanced EMTs. EMS reported receiving 10 new applications recently after a long drought, easing staffing concerns.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:23:29 Sheriff Fund Transfers (Dept. 129 & 145)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner / Jail administration.

- **Deliberation Summary:** Routine salary adjustments for sergeants, corporals, deputies, lieutenants, and correctional officers (net zero total).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:25:54 Addendum 2: Circuit Court Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Emily Anderson, Court Administrator.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Emergency transfer moving a pre-trial screening analyst into a probation officer position due to a resignation effective August 4th. A last-minute exception was granted to expedite hiring.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:28:48 County General Fund Transfers: Commissioners (Dept. 153)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Commissioners' office / Administration.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Requested \$50,000 for postage, \$50,000 for Justice Center maintenance, and \$20,000 for returning fugitives (total \$120,000). Lengthy debate ensued regarding postage rate increases (approx. 5-10%), high-volume voter list maintenance mailings, building maintenance complexities (Justice Center HVAC filters, proprietary plumbing parts, chiller repairs), and fugitive extradition costs.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved (Mr. Webb voting "No").
- **00:46:13 Coroner Fund Transfers (Dept. 133)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Brianna Reed, Coroner's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Transferred \$19,392 to operating supplies for five handheld radios enabling direct communication on-scene with dispatch, police, and EMS. The office previously relied on personal cell phones and phone calls. Grant-funded cameras (\$349 each) were also acquired to avoid subpoenaing personal cell phones containing crime scene photos.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **00:51:34 Grant & Sales Disclosure Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chuck Zimmer / James Carmichael.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Withdrew an ARP line item; approved \$5,000 Ball Brothers grant transfer for HTCU renovations planning; approved Assessor sales disclosure fund transfers (\$100 mileage, \$3,000 schooling, \$3,200 computer replacement).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote / Roll Call.
- **01:00:06 Ordinance Update: Salary Ordinance 2023-16 (Federal Inmate Transporters)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Sheriff Tony Skinner.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Created a new part-time line item to hire special deputies dedicated exclusively to transporting federal inmates from the jail to federal court in Indianapolis or medical facilities. Fully reimbursed by the U.S. Marshals Service (hourly rate \$24 plus mileage).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** A unanimous procedural vote (01:05:07) permitted immediate adoption. **Passed Unanimously** by roll call vote.

Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- *No members of the public signed up or spoke during the general public comment period (01:20:42).*
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Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Together, D.M. Board Appointments:** Council nominated and selected six representatives for the Together, D.M. board: Vicki Gasaway, Jacob case, Rob Kiesling, Joe Russell, Stephen Brand, and Tony Johnson (01:06:03).
 - **HR & Department Updates:** Pam Hammond (HR Director) reported all departmental job descriptions were submitted on time for review by Wagner (01:33:20). Sheriff Skinner provided a 6-month jail food cost update, noting meal costs increased from \$1.60 to \$1.89 due to inflation, despite serving ~40,000 fewer meals compared to the previous year (01:34:17).
 - **Live-Streaming Authorization:** Motion by Ryan, seconded by Bill, to contract with Endpoint Creative (~\$2,000 for the first 20 hours, \$80/hr thereafter) to live-stream upcoming Council budget hearings on YouTube. **Approved by Roll Call Vote** (01:28:47).
 - **Noteworthy Announcements & Highway Updates:**
 - Council acknowledged the local fair, memorial services for Jane, and praised the Highway Department (Tommy and Carrie) for managing severe traffic complications and local detours stemming from the State Road 332 construction and railway safety closures (01:29:46).
 - Noted upcoming Ball Brothers Foundation breakfast/brunch meeting for elected officials on August 31st (01:29:47).
 - Noted judicial updates: Governor appointed Doug Maher as new judge of Delaware Circuit Court 3 starting September 1st, and recognized Judge Wolf's retirement after 36 years of service (01:31:41).
 - **Adjournment:** Official meeting adjourned at 01:38:03 following a motion by Dan and second by Eugene.
 - **Next Meeting:** Tuesday, August 22nd at 9:00 AM, with budget hearings beginning Wednesday, September 6th (01:38:14).
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